

Grand Unification: The Spiral of Fate and Freedom

An Abductive Synthesis of the Gray Zone Series

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This paper is submitted not as a verified physical theory but as a philosophical synthesis that recovers the entire five-paper series into a single structure. It adds no new domain; through the single axis of the spiral of fate and freedom, it shows why Papers 1–4 are recovered as one system. It applies throughout the Two-Layer Separation principle established earlier (descriptive layer = observed natural patterns / normative layer = designable human tools).

Abstract

This study is a synthesis that recovers the Gray Zone series (Papers 1–4) into a single integrated structure. The central claim is simple — the axis that recovers Papers 1–4 post hoc with the fewest assumptions and most coherently is the spiral of fate and freedom. Beginning from fate (the structural limit of cognition), passing through the cognition that gazes at that limit, traversing the Gray Zone that mediates opposition, arriving at the realization of freedom, and that freedom in turn becoming the condition of a new fate — this cycle is the coherent form that recovers Papers 1–4. The study renders this spiral as the schema $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ and recovers Paper 1 (the mediation principle), Paper 2 (the baryonic epistemic ceiling), Paper 3 (grand unified cosmology), and Paper 4 (AGI political economy) each as one moment of the spiral. The analytic contribution of this paper (Paper 5) is this: recovered through this spiral, the crisis of the AGI transition appears as a structural deprivation of freedom that distributive remedies alone cannot reach — the simultaneous erosion of political legitimacy, epistemic truth, and existential subjecthood — and these three form a single mutually reinforcing descending spiral that no single distributive remedy alone is sufficient to reverse, and the simultaneous operation of the three mediations turns it into an ascending spiral (the three crises are what Paper 4 § 2.7 diagnosed as irreducible to distribution, which Paper 5 structures as a spiral). The final claim is the study's own — fate and freedom are not two opposed worlds but one process co-generated within the Gray Zone.

On the series' unverifiability — not a confession of weakness but a self-referential performative argument. The series concedes that it cannot be verified in the manner of quantitative physics, but that concession is not an excuse — it is structural: to declare a cognitive limit absolutely closed already presupposes access to what is declared closed, so the limit is reaffirmed by the very act that denies it. Yet what this argument shows reaches only the formal fact; its substantive grounds depend on the independent arguments of each paper below. This is not an argument that proves anything positively, but a self-referential argument that exposes the self-instability of an absolute-closure proposition. The value of this framework therefore lies not in a contest of verification but in the extension of explanatory scope.

Keywords: Gray Zone; the spiral of fate and freedom; grand unification; $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$; Two-Layer Separation; baryonic epistemic ceiling; AGI transition; legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood; Unus Mundus; the mediated whole

AI Use Disclosure. The core problem framing, principal direction, and final judgments of this paper rest

with the author. Generative AI was used for structuring the work of recovering Papers 1–4 into the spiral schema, for checking counterarguments, and for drafting and proofreading prose. Responsibility for all claims and errors in the final manuscript rests with the author.

1. Introduction: Why Unification

Work spanning five papers has reached its end. Paper 1 established the Gray Zone principle that mediates opposition; Paper 2 charted the baryonic ceiling of cognition; Paper 3 extended the two into a cosmology; Paper 4 brought them down into the institutional design of the AGI transition. On the surface these lie scattered across philosophy, cosmology, and economics. The study's claim is that the scattering is only apparent.

The central thesis of this study — and what this paper makes explicit for the first time — is this: the axis that recovers Papers 1–4 post hoc with the fewest assumptions and most coherently is the spiral of fate and freedom. From fate to freedom and on to a new fate, this spiral is the form that recovers the entire series. Each paper is read as one moment of this spiral, and the task of Paper 5 is to bring that spiral explicitly into view, showing why Papers 1–4 are recovered as one system.

Abductive synthesis, not post-hoc rationalization. Here an honest objection is pre-empted. ‘If the spine is first made explicit in Paper 5, is it not a construction imposed after the fact rather than a discovery? Could not any sufficiently abstract schema be found in any heterogeneous texts after the fact?’ The objection is legitimate, and the study answers in two ways. First, the spiral was not arbitrarily projected onto Papers 1–4; it is recoverable from what each paper chose and excluded in its composition. That Paper 1 treated mediation ‘between two poles,’ that Paper 2 took ‘limit’ as its starting point, that Paper 3 opened that axis by explicitly delegating its existential implications (fate and freedom) to this Paper 5 — these choices were not random but presupposed the fate↔freedom structure. Second, the method here is not deduction but abductive synthesis (abduction — inference to the best explanation). Abductive synthesis is not invalidated merely by being post hoc — so long as it explains more of Papers 1–4 with fewer assumptions than rival schemata, it is a legitimate philosophical method. Why the spiral, unlike genealogy and paradigm, reads that recurrence as a normative spiral conditioned on the realization of freedom is argued in §2. This study does not claim that Papers 1–4 consciously developed this axis from the start; it shows that, viewed post hoc, the fate↔freedom axis recovers the most connections with the fewest assumptions.

This study therefore adds no new theory. Neither a new cosmology, nor a new economic policy, nor new physics. What it does is recovery. Without re-arguing the four already-submitted papers, it assigns coordinates — which moment of the single axis of the spiral of fate and freedom each was. Recovery and new claim are strictly separated. Part II contains only recovery; Part III contains only Paper 5's own new claim — and there too, as §7 makes explicit, the ‘new claim’ is the structuring of material Paper 4 already diagnosed, not its first discovery.

One reading caution is needed. The study recovers Papers 1–4 not in publication order (1→2→3→4) but in the structural order of the spiral (fate→mediation→freedom→institution). The recovery order of Part II is therefore Paper 2 (fate)→Paper 1 (mediation)→Paper 3 (freedom)→Paper 4 (institution). This is not a re-narration of chronology but a coordinatization

of each paper on the structural map of the spiral. This coordinatization points to ‘the moment each paper opens.’ Papers 1, 2, and 4 carry and develop the moment they open within their own text; Paper 3 opens the cosmological foundation of the freedom moment but delegates its existential development to Paper 5.

2. The Form of the Spiral: $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ and Two-Layer Separation

To use the spiral as an integrative coordinate, a form that compresses its operation is needed. Introduced as a notational device by Paper 1 § 3.3 — its formal justification delegated to Paper 3 — and with Paper 3 fixing the ‘4’ as the four moments (正·中·反·合), the $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ schema is recovered here and applied to the mediating form of the master opposition fate and freedom. This is an application of that schema, not a redefinition; it does not alter the definition Paper 3 fixed.

(On series consistency of the ‘4’.) Paper 4’s ‘series-consistency note’ records that Papers 1–2 used ‘4’ as structured multiplicity / ‘complete structuration,’ whereas Paper 3 fixed it as the four moments (正·中·反·合). This paper adopts Paper 3’s fixed definition and, like Paper 4, inherits the divergence as a recorded publication residue rather than concealing it. Nothing in the spiral argument depends on the abandoned spatial reading.

0 is the undifferentiated potential. 1 is the first opposition — here, fate: the awareness of the limit that constitutes the subject. 4 is the transition through mediation, the self-completing minimal unit of four moments — the 正·反·合 commonly attributed to Hegel (Fichtean in origin, popularized as the Hegel attribution by Chalybäus) with the mediating 中 added: 正 (zhèng, fate); 中 (zhōng, the mediating Gray Zone); 反 (fǎn, resistance to the limit); 合 (hé, the realization of freedom). Here 中 is at once one of the four moments (中₁) and, as § 8 shows, the principal aspect that mediates 正·反·合 as a whole (中₂) — the same word used at different analytic layers, where 中₂ is the recursive application of 中₁, not an independent second principle. Hereafter, when ‘中’ is written simply it denotes the moment-中 (中₁), and the higher mediating operator is marked 中₂. ∞ is ascent through endless repetition, in which each realization of freedom becomes the condition of a new fate (the sense of ∞ follows Paper 1’s ‘open whole’ as refined by Paper 3 into ‘irreversible ascent’). The arrow $\leftrightarrow$ is not a mathematical equality but an ontological relation — distinct phases as cross-sections of one process — and does not conflict with the irreversibility of ascent encoded by ∞ (it inherits Paper 3’s resolution of the reversibility tension).

The four 正·中·反·合 moments and the four recovery moments are not the same set. The non-correspondence structure is as follows:

Recovery moment	Relation to 正·中·反·合	Character
Fate (Paper 2)	正	single correspondence
Mediation (Paper 1)	中 ₁	single correspondence
Freedom (Papers 3 and 5)	反 + 合 (individual layer)	absorbs two moments
Institution (Paper 4)	re-instantiation of the whole spiral at the social layer	not a single coordinate (operation = 中, outcome = 合)

∞ is not one of these four moments but the spiral's ascent, in which each realization of freedom becomes the condition of a new fate and the four moments repeat; its concept rests on Paper 1's 'open whole' and Paper 3's 'irreversible ascent' (§ 2). The two quartets are thus two resolutions of the same spiral.

Here the spiral of fate and freedom is fixed as a form. The spiral is the $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ process mediating the single master opposition fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom, and every other opposition the series treated (order/chaos, 5%/95%, capital/labor) is a domain-specific manifestation of this master opposition. This schematization blocks the indiscriminate reading that 'every opposition is the Gray Zone.' Not every opposition is indiscriminately the Gray Zone; rather, the single master opposition fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom manifests specifically in each domain, and each manifestation — under the layer distinction § 9 makes explicit — must clear Paper 1's classification discipline to be recognized as the Gray Zone.

Why is fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom the master opposition? This axis is chosen methodologically, and that choice is argued to cover more, with fewer assumptions, than rival candidates. Comparing which candidate axis covers the whole series gives the following.

Candidate axis	Papers covered	Verdict
capital $\leftrightarrow$ labor	Paper 4	Papers 1, 2, and 3 uncovered
order $\leftrightarrow$ chaos	Papers 1 and 3	Papers 2 and 4 uncovered
5% $\leftrightarrow$ 95%	Papers 2 and 3	Papers 1 and 4 uncovered
limit $\leftrightarrow$ transcendence · determinism $\leftrightarrow$ agency · closure $\leftrightarrow$ openness	All of Papers 1–4	Coverage equal, but adjacent variants (partially overlapping axes) of fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom
fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom	All of Papers 1–4	Coverage equal → adopted on the generative and existential reading

This table uses a two-stage filter. The first stage is coverage — capital $\leftrightarrow$ labor, order $\leftrightarrow$ chaos, and 5% $\leftrightarrow$ 95% are eliminated for failing to cover the whole series. The second stage is interpretive power — limit $\leftrightarrow$ transcendence, determinism $\leftrightarrow$ agency, and closure $\leftrightarrow$ openness are tied candidates with equal coverage, and the interpretive-power criterion is applied to them (not a change of criterion, but a second-stage filter applied to ties after the first stage). These three are not synonyms of fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom but adjacent variants (partially overlapping axes) leaning respectively toward epistemology, the theory of action, and systems theory — fate, for instance, is not equivalent to determinism (the study takes the spiral's outcome to be a conditional result depending on the agent's choice and on whether mediation operates, not a necessity). Fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom was chosen because, in the study's judgment, it has the highest existential and philosophical synthetic power. This axis resonates directly with the core opposition of Camus' Myth of Sisyphus — freedom through lucid revolt against fate ('there is no fate that cannot be surmounted by scorn,' 'Absurd Freedom') — and continues the vocabulary of fate, freedom, and mediation in which Papers 1–4 were already described (because Camus also uses the vocabulary of limit $\leftrightarrow$ transcendence, this resonance is not the sole reading; but in internal coherence and synthetic power, fate $\leftrightarrow$ freedom is the most fundamental recovery coordinate). The hierarchy of 'master opposition' is not a metaphysical-priority claim but a methodological choice, and in this the series does not adopt the historical necessity Hegel ascribed to the dialectic (the spiral's outcome is not a necessity but a conditional result depending on the agent's choice and on whether mediation operates). As an integrative form, the spiral has one explanatory point that

distinguishes it from competing integrative frames. Foucault's principal concern is not a normative spiral but the genealogical emergence of power/knowledge formations; Kuhn presents the structure of normal science's repeated re-settling but does not read it as a normative spiral conditioned on the realization of freedom. This series' spiral schematizes, through the ∞ moment, precisely that return — the cycle in which the realization of freedom becomes the condition of a new fate — as a normative spiral conditioned on the realization of freedom. Kuhn's recurrence is descriptive and value-neutral, and Foucault's genealogy is anti-teleological and critical, so neither reads that recurrence normatively; this normative schematization is the explanatory point the spiral adds.

The Two-Layer Separation principle. This spiral operates differently on two layers. On the descriptive layer (nature) the spiral is an observed pattern — a form structurally analogous to (not identified with) self-organizing patterns such as Prigogine's dissipative structures — which humans cannot strengthen. On the normative layer (human affairs) the spiral is a designable tool — institutions, education, the epistemic base. 'Strengthening' has meaning only in the latter. The whole paper is subordinate to this distinction, which becomes the key device controlling the scope within which the spiral can be normatively applied.

3. The Moment of Fate — Recovering Paper 2: The Baryonic Epistemic Ceiling

The first moment of the spiral is fate. Paper 2 formalized the structural limit of cognition as the baryonic epistemic ceiling. Only about 5% of the observable universe is baryonic matter; the remaining 95% is inferred only indirectly through gravitational effects, and the very instrument of cognition, the brain, is itself baryonic matter — from which follows the claim that human cognition is structurally disadvantaged with respect to the non-baryonic domain.

The study does not re-argue this claim (Paper 2 already did). What it does is assign a coordinate — the baryonic ceiling is the fate (正) moment of the spiral. It is not a punishment imposed from outside but a limit that constitutes the cognizing subject from within — a limit in precisely the sense of fate. Paper 2's position, restricting this ceiling to a falsifiable tendency-claim rather than a metaphysical assertion, is also inherited. What is fixed as fate is the medium of cognition (baryonic), not a verdict that the 95% is forever closed.

This coordinatization matters because fate is the starting point of the spiral. A being with no limit has no freedom to realize, only motion. The proposition of § 5 and § 10 — that the awareness of fate first opens the space of freedom — has its ground here, in Paper 2's epistemic ceiling.

4. The Moment of Mediation — Recovering Paper 1: The Gray Zone Principle

The second moment of the spiral is mediation. Paper 1 defined the Gray Zone as the field of active mediation operating between two opposed forces while they coexist. It is neither an arithmetic midpoint, nor a compromise that softens opposition, nor a residue after opposition has ended. It is a dynamic mediating state that absorbs and converts the energy of opposition, giving the system a form in which it does not collapse.

The study recovers the Gray Zone as the mediation (中) moment of the spiral. What mediates between fate (the limit) and freedom (its realization) is precisely the Gray Zone. Paper 1's classification apparatus that makes this mediation testable — the qualitative properties of § 3.1 (measurable mediating character, rising option value, equilibrium-seeking cyclicity) and the operational criteria of § 3.2 — is decisive here too. These become the gating discipline (§ 9) that keeps Paper 5's new claim (applying the Gray Zone to the three manifestations of the deprivation of freedom) in Part III from sliding into indiscriminate application.

Mediation is the center of the spiral because the transition from fate to freedom does not occur without it. To deny the limit (a failure of mediation) is to be crushed by fate or to falsely declare a transcendence of the limit. The Gray Zone is the third way that neither denies nor submits to the limit but gazes at and converts it, and this way is structurally analogous, in the relevant respect, to Camus' revolt (§ 5).

5. The Moment of Freedom — The Absurd and Revolt

The third moment of the spiral is freedom. The existential development of this moment is Paper 5's own work. Since Paper 3 treats only its cosmological and structural foundation and explicitly delegated the existential implications (fate, revolt, and freedom) to this paper, the reading below — the epistemic ceiling as fate, Camus' revolt as the active mediation of that fate, freedom as what only one who first recognizes its deprivation realizes — is not Paper 3's recovery but Paper 5's own development. (Paper 3's cosmological body — the $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ schema and the structural-coordinatization table — is recovered separately in § 2. On the four-moment map the coordinate of 'freedom' splits in two: the conditions of possibility of freedom belong to Paper 3, and the existential development of freedom to Paper 5. The shorthand 'freedom = Paper 3' therefore means that Paper 3 opens the cosmological coordinate connected to the freedom moment — not the content of freedom — and does not refer to the whole text of that paper.)

The study develops this delegated axis as the freedom (合) moment of the spiral, and here the spiral of fate and freedom secures its ground within the series. Camus' absurd is the site where the baryonic intellect (反), demanding total intelligibility and resisting the limit, collides with the silence of the 95% reachable only by gravitational inference — fate (正). Revolt is the lucid refusal that neither denies nor submits to that limit — mediation (中). Sisyphus is the figure of this revolt (The Myth of Sisyphus, 1942). The cognizer who, facing the ceiling ceaselessly, does not give up the climb is the 'happy Sisyphus.' The rock is the ceiling, the slope is the spiral, lucidity is revolt.

Methodological note. The identification 'Camus' revolt = the Gray Zone's mediation (中)' is the author's philosophical reinterpretation, not Camus' own self-understanding. Camus in fact explicitly opposed Hegelian historical dialectic (The Rebel, 1951) and did not formalize revolt as a dialectical concept of mediation. The study does not identify the whole of Camus' revolt with 中 but draws an analogy between the Gray Zone's mediation and one aspect — lucid persistence before the absurd that is neither submission nor nihilistic negation. The study borrows only this aspect of Camus' revolt, 'the lucid refusal that is neither submission nor negation,' as a mediation concept, and acknowledges that Camus' revolt as a whole includes solidarity, limit, and shared dignity.

Here a decisive proposition holds. The recognition of the limit is one of the decisive conditions under which reflective freedom is opened. A being aware of no ceiling has no freedom to realize. Lucid awareness of fate — of the ceiling, of the silence of the 95% — first opens the space in which

a free act can be distinguished from a mere reaction. Awareness of the limit is not the end of freedom but the condition of its emergence. This proposition leads directly into the concluding proposition of § 10.

6. The Moment of Institution — Recovering Paper 4: Keynesian-Style Transition Stabilization

The fourth moment of the spiral is institution. Paper 4 treats the special case in which the spiral of fate and freedom descends into social structure. When the structural limit of labor displacement and capital concentration (fate) arrives in the AGI transition, converting that limit, through Gray Zone mediation (asset-based distribution and epistemic base), into the condition of a new social freedom — this is what Paper 4 calls Keynesian-style transition stabilization through Gray Zone mediation.

This study inherits Paper 4's caution in naming. Paper 4 § 3 deliberately refuses to elevate this operation into a named ‘-ism’ (‘the Gray Zone is not a destination but a method’). The study therefore coins neither ‘Gray Zone Keynesianism’ nor any ideological label of that kind, and throughout refers only to the operation of transition stabilization, never to a regime.

The study recovers Paper 4 as the institutional manifestation of the spiral, but does not over-extend that institutional stabilization into Paper 5's central axis. It is one special form the spiral takes at the economic and institutional layer, not the spiral itself. Paper 4's view of capital concentration as a self-contradiction that destroys capital's own demand base is the concise translation of the spiral logic that unmediated abandonment to fate results not in freedom but in shared collapse.

The significance of institution in the spiral is this — the realization of freedom must not remain in the individual's interior but be objectified into social structure. If Camus' revolt (§ 5) is the freedom of individual existence, Paper 4's institutional transition stabilization is that freedom crystallized into institution. Yet Paper 4 too is only one moment of the spiral. The realization of freedom does not end with institution but becomes the condition of a new fate, continuing the spiral.

7. The Cross-Section of the Spiral — Three Manifestations of the Deprivation of Freedom

From here begins what Paper 5 raises as its own contribution. That contribution must be stated precisely, because Paper 4 already did part of it. Paper 4 § 2.7 already diagnosed legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood as three crises irreducible to distribution. What Paper 5 adds is not their discovery but their structuring — placing those three as cross-sections of a single spiral, specifying the fate-coordinate each occupies, and, newly, specifying their cycle $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$ (§ 8). The relation to Paper 4 is therefore not duplication or competition over origin but a division of labor: Paper 4 diagnosed their irreducibility, and Paper 5 structures it as a spiral. The ‘concrete mediation’ that Paper 4 delegates to Paper 5 is developed here as the structural mediation direction of the three crises. This paper structures that direction as a spiral, and the mediation offered here is at the structural level.

The core insight is this. The three crises are not separate events but cross-sections in which a single fate — the structural deprivation of freedom — manifests simultaneously across three layers. In the AGI transition the human is simultaneously deprived of the freedom of decision (politics), the freedom of judgment (epistemic), and the freedom of self-definition (existential). These three are not an exhaustive list of the deprivation of freedom but the three major cross-sections Paper 4 already diagnosed. This three-fold (legitimacy, truth, subjecthood) resonates with Foucault's three axes of knowledge, power, and subjectivation, with Zuboff's analysis of surveillance capitalism, and with Arendt's account of the destruction of the person; the contribution here is not the discovery of this three-fold but its synthesis, as the spiral of fate and freedom, and its application to the AGI transition. The three deprivations are three cross-sections of the same spiral. To state it in advance: all three manifestations are three faces of the 正 (fate) moment; their cycle (§ 8) is not the four moments 正 · 中 · 反 · 合 but feedback within 正, and mediation (中) operates at the layer above.

Layer	Mode of deprivation of freedom	Spiral coordinate
A. Political legitimacy	Who sets the rules of the AGI transition — procedural and inclusive defects deprive the freedom of collective decision	Fate (正): structural concentration of decision power
B. Epistemic truth	What counts as true — the asymmetry between production and verification deprives the freedom of judgment	Fate (正): structural bottleneck of verification
C. Existential subjecthood	What am I — role dissolution deprives the freedom of self-definition	Fate (正): structural dissolution of identity grounds

7.1 Political Legitimacy: the freedom of decision

The first cross-section is legitimacy. The question of who sets the rules of the AGI transition arises not from a technocratic deficit of competence but from a procedural and inclusive deficit of decision-making. When common reference points dissolve, standard-setting bodies are dominated by a few, and citizens' contestation is foreclosed, the freedom of collective decision is deprived. This is the form the fate moment takes at the political layer. The task of mediation is to recover the freedom of decision through procedural legitimation — inclusive reconstruction and the recovery of common reference points.

7.2 Epistemic Truth: the freedom of judgment

The second cross-section is truth. As computing scales, the cost of AI knowledge production plummets while the cost of human verification is biologically fixed, so a structural asymmetry — the verification bottleneck — arises. Under this bottleneck, truth is in practice displaced from correspondence with reality to computational plausibility, and the human is reduced to a verification residue stripped of the freedom of judgment. This is how the fate moment manifests at the epistemic layer. This analysis extends Paper 2's baryonic ceiling into the AGI context — where the ceiling was a natural limit, the verification bottleneck is its artificial, accelerated reproduction. The task of mediation is the redesign of the epistemic base — verification priorities, verification chains, provisional-knowledge categories.

7.3 Existential Subjecthood: the freedom of self-definition

The third cross-section is subjecthood. Since modernity, human self-definition has leaned on labor, cognition, and social role, and AGI erodes these three axes simultaneously. In the void where roles dissolve, the human loses the freedom of self-definition. Yet here the reversal of the spiral occurs. As Sartre formulated, in an age when role is not a sufficient condition of self-definition, the subject must define itself through choice, responsibility, and relation — and the proposition ‘existence precedes essence’ is paradoxically strengthened. Camus, unlike Sartre, did not lean on the thesis that existence precedes essence and affirmed a shared essence — the dignity shared by all humans; but his revolt — ‘I rebel, therefore we exist’ (The Rebel, 1951) — shows that even where role is stripped away the subject reaffirms its subjecthood against the violation of that shared dignity. For Camus this reaffirmation is not isolated self-creation but proceeds through the acknowledgment of limit and solidarity with others, so the subjecthood recovered here is at once individual and communal. The freedom of self-definition opens in a new form only to one who recognizes the deprivation of role. Here the proposition § 5 established — ‘the recognition of the limit is the condition of freedom’ — is reaffirmed at the subjecthood layer. The task of mediation is ontological mediation — the recognition of non-labor value, a base of meaning, the recovery of communal subjecthood.

8. The Cycle of the Three Manifestations and the Integrative Horizon

The three cross-sections are not independent. When legitimacy collapses, the shared standard of truth-judgment dissolves ($A \rightarrow B$); when the truth regime is shaken, the subject loses its epistemic self-ground ($B \rightarrow C$); when subjecthood dissolves, citizens' political will weakens, further eroding legitimacy ($C \rightarrow A$). This $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$ cycle is a spiral in which the deprivation of freedom strengthens itself — a descending spiral. No single remedy alone breaks it. Stabilizing one layer alone, while the other two are still under way, lets it reverse again. The three manifestations are all three faces of the 正 (fate) moment (§ 7), and this cycle does not turn through the four moments 正·中·反·合 but is a self-strengthening feedback within that 正. 中 (mediation) is not one link inside this loop but — as 中₂, the operator in which the same mediating action as the moment-中 (中₁) is recursively applied at a larger scale — reverses the loop's direction from descending to ascending. That is, 中₂ is the recursive application of 中₁, not an independent second principle. Recursive application means that the mediating logic of 中₁ — ‘the transition that neither denies nor submits’ — operates identically at the level of the $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$ loop.

But the spiral is bidirectional. If the deprivation of freedom is a self-strengthening descending spiral, the simultaneous operation of mediation opens an ascending spiral in which the realization of freedom strengthens itself. When procedural legitimation (A), the epistemic base (B), and ontological mediation (C) operate together, the recovered freedom of decision supports the freedom of judgment, which supports the freedom of self-definition, which in turn strengthens political freedom. The descending and ascending spirals are two directions of the same structure, and which way it turns depends on whether mediation operates.

Unus Mundus. Jung gave the name Unus Mundus to the integrative horizon where matter and psyche are no longer two worlds but are unified into one. This horizon — where opposition is unified into a single whole, which Jung saw in the coincidence of opposites (coincidentia oppositorum; *Mysterium Coniunctionis*) — is also what Hegel's synthesis (合), Prigogine's

dissipative structures, and Camus's revolt have each pointed at in a different domain. The study references *Unus Mundus* only as a normative-layer comparative coordinate, and does not adopt Jung's archetypal and parapsychological implications as a metaphysical system. The spiral of fate↔freedom is not a renaming of *Unus Mundus* but a structure that develops, on the different axis of fate↔freedom, the same form in which opposition is unified into a single whole.

9. Limits and Objections — Controlling Indiscriminate Application

The study's risk is clear. The moment the spiral of fate↔freedom and Gray Zone mediation are applied to all three layers — political, epistemic, and existential — the very trap Paper 1 closed with its criteria, the trap that ‘every opposition is the Gray Zone,’ reopens. This section controls that risk head-on, and does so under the very layer discipline Paper 4 § 2.7 adopted, so that Papers 4 and 5 say the same thing about the same three objects.

The gating principle, stated precisely. Paper 1 § 3.2 takes as falsification triggers (i) measurable intermediate states and (iii) the absence of a dominant signal under a pre-registered variance decomposition, and treats (ii) rising option value only as a classification gate. For normative-domain objects such as legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood, criteria (i) and (iii) are generally not well-defined — there is no pre-registered variance decomposition for ‘legitimacy.’ The study therefore follows Paper 4 § 2.7 in substance and does not claim that the three manifestations pass those quantitative triggers. Strictly read, they are partly out of scope. What the study claims is a weaker and more honest position — the three manifestations pass Paper 1 § 3.1's qualitative-property filter (dynamic mediating character, creative indeterminacy, equilibrium-oriented cyclicity), and this is the indispensable filter against indiscriminate application. An application that fails even this qualitative filter is not recognized as Gray Zone mediation and remains mere metaphor.

The table below records, for each manifestation, candidate indicators that could be operationalized, together with the § 3.1 qualitative properties each already exhibits — noting that these are only candidate indicators, not yet operationalized, and not a passing of the § 3.2 triggers.

Manifestation	Candidate intermediate-state indicator	Candidate option-value indicator	Candidate ‘no dominant signal’ indicator
Political legitimacy	Provisional governance and public sphere and standard-setting process	Increase in participation channels and policy options	No monopoly of decision by any single firm, state, or technocratic body
Epistemic truth	Provisional knowledge and pending-verification state and verification chains	Increase in plural verification paths and judgment-deferral capacity	No monopoly of truth-status by a single model's output
Existential subjecthood	Non-labor identity and transitional role and communal space of meaning	Increase in the possibility of self-definition	No monopoly of human value by labor and occupation alone

These cells are candidates for operationalization, not operationalized or empirically verified in this paper. On the § 3.1 qualitative grounds alone, the three manifestations are genuine candidate cases — qualitatively in scope, quantitatively out of scope — which is the same verdict Paper 4 § 2.7 renders.

Other limits. First, since the study's spiral thesis is a post-hoc synthesis of Papers 1–4, if any one paper is independently refuted, the corresponding moment of the spiral must be reconsidered. Second, the three-layer analysis (§ 7) is a structural hypothesis empirically verifiable and falsifiable as the AGI transition proceeds, not a fixed prediction. Third, the study is a philosophical synthesis, not a verified theory, and its value lies not in a contest of verification but in the extension of explanatory scope.

10. Conclusion: The Mediated Whole, and Fate and Freedom

The study has recovered the five-paper Gray Zone series into a single structure. Paper 1's mediation principle, Paper 2's epistemic ceiling, Paper 3's cosmological extension, and Paper 4's institutional application were not four scattered domains but the four moments of one spine — the spiral of fate and freedom. The $0 \leftrightarrow 1 \leftrightarrow 4 \leftrightarrow \infty$ form compresses that spiral, the Two-Layer Separation controls its application, and the three manifestations of the deprivation of freedom (legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood) showed the concrete cross-section the spiral takes in the AGI transition.

The analytic contribution of this paper (Paper 5) is this. As § 7–§ 8 showed, the crisis of the AGI transition is a structural deprivation of freedom that distributive remedies alone cannot reach; legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood form a mutually reinforcing descending spiral; and the simultaneous operation of the three mediations turns it into an ascending spiral.

On why unverifiability is not the verdict it appears to be. The series cannot be verified in the manner of quantitative physics, and has said so at every step. But that is not the weakness it is taken to be. The series stands on a reflective and self-referential structure — the act of denying a cognitive limit reaffirms it (distinct in form from the Cartesian cogito, it belongs to the family of self-referential performative arguments — performative self-refutation). To declare the limit closed already presupposes access to what is declared closed. It is in precisely this respect that the series, through the act of gazing at the epistemic ceiling, shows that ‘there is no absolutely closed cognition.’ Yet what this argument establishes reaches only the formal fact; the ceiling's concrete content (baryonic) depends on Paper 2's independent argument. Metaphysical-level unverifiability is therefore not a fatal defect within a philosophical synthesis — though limiting for any empirical theory — but the exact form in which a claim with self-referential structure presents itself — and this framework asks to be judged not as a ground of prediction but precisely on that ground.

The philosophical concluding proposition of the whole five-paper series — encompassing the analytic contribution above — is this. Fate and freedom are not two opposed worlds but one process co-generated within the Gray Zone. Fate is not the opposite of freedom but its condition. The very act of gazing at the limit is already the beginning of the movement that transcends it — not by changing the fixed medium (that is what fate fixed) but by mediation transforming one's relation to the disadvantage the medium imposes. And freedom is realized not above the ceiling but in the manner of standing beneath it. Only one who knows fate can be free, and that freedom becomes the condition of a new fate, and so the spiral continues.

Recovered post hoc, the work of five papers is read as this one spiral. Beginning at the epistemic ceiling, passing through the Gray Zone that mediates it, arriving at the freedom realized through revolt, objectified into institution, tested by the crises of three layers, and returning again to fate — a ceaseless ascending spiral. The enemy was not fate. The enemy was unmediated transition

— the collapse of refusing to gaze at fate and either falsely declaring freedom or submitting to fate. The spiral of fate and freedom is another name for the mediation that refuses that collapse.

Propositions

Proposition	Content
Proposition 1	The axis that recovers Papers 1–4 with the fewest assumptions is the spiral of fate and freedom.
Proposition 2	The four moments of the spiral — fate (Paper 2), mediation (Paper 1), freedom (Papers 3 and 5), institution (Paper 4) — constitute the series, with Papers 1, 2, and 4 carrying and developing their moment, and the freedom moment split into conditions of possibility (Paper 3) and existential development (Paper 5).
Proposition 3	The spiral is concretized in the AGI transition as three manifestations of the deprivation of freedom (legitimacy, truth, and subjecthood), which Paper 4 § 2.7 diagnosed and Paper 5 structures as a spiral.
Proposition 4	The three manifestations cycle as $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$, and the simultaneous operation of the three mediations turns the descending spiral into an ascending one.
Proposition 5	The three-layer mediation is recognized as a candidate Gray Zone only when it passes Paper 1 § 3.1's qualitative-property filter, and the § 3.2 quantitative triggers remain out of scope for these normative objects (consistent with Paper 4 § 2.7).

Publication Timetable

No.	Title	Status
1	The Gray Zone Principle: The Mediating Mechanism of Systemic Transition and Equilibrium	Published
2	The Baryonic Epistemological Ceiling: Cognitive Limits in a 5% Observable Universe	Published
3	Grand Unified Cosmology: A Four-Entity Theory for Transcending Binary Polarization	Published
4	The Political Economy of AGI Transition: Labor Displacement, Capital Concentration, and Gray-Zone Mediation	Published
5	Grand Unification: The Spiral of Fate and Freedom (this paper)	This paper

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Jung, S. *Grand Unified Cosmology (Paper 3)*. SSRN, 2026.

Jung, S. *The Political Economy of AGI Transition (Paper 4)*. SSRN, 2026.